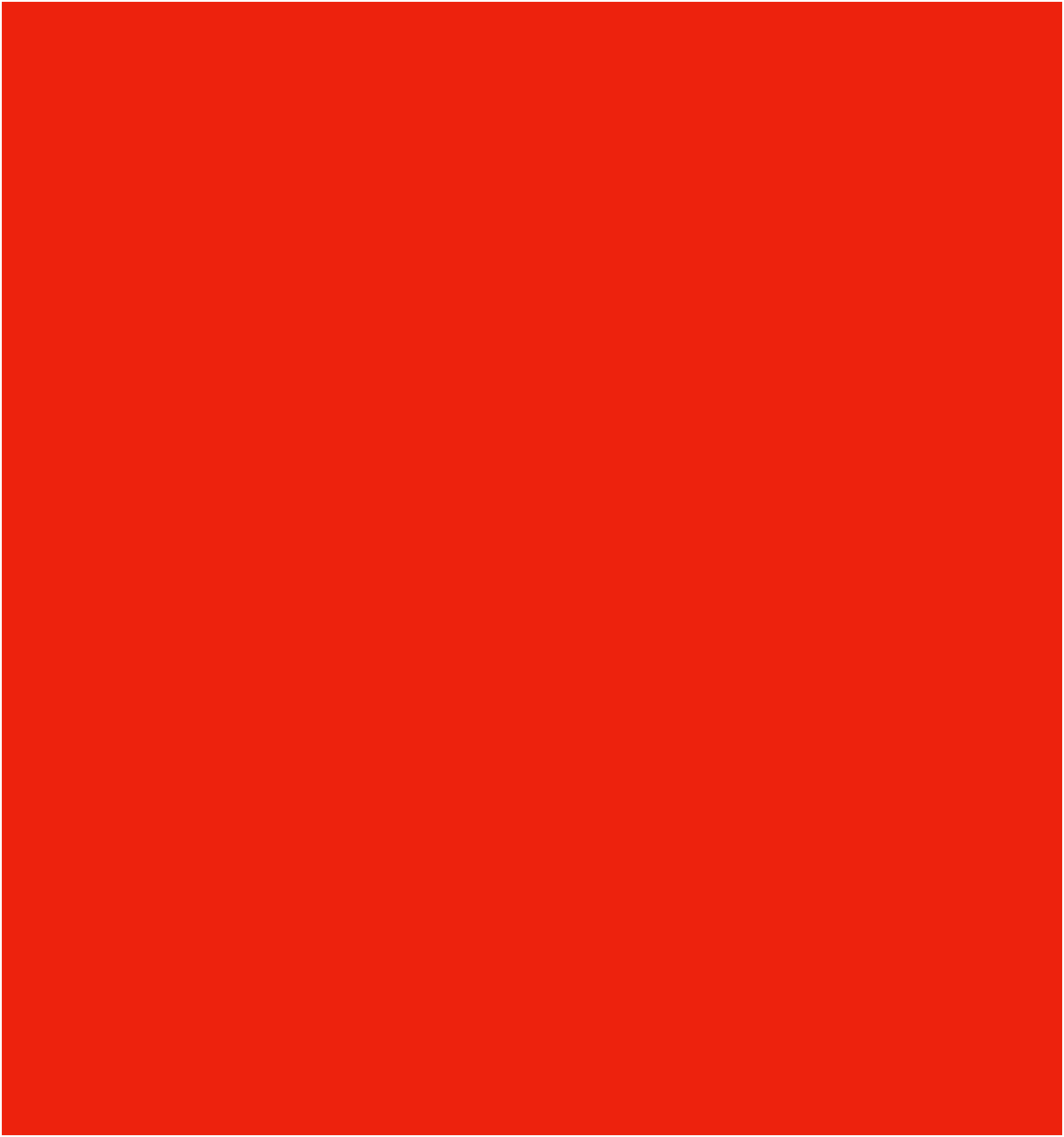










the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are aged 65 and over has increased from 10.5 million to 12.5 million, and the number of people aged 75 and over has increased from 4.5 million to 6.5 million (Office of National Statistics 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of older people in the community. The Department of Health (1999) has published a strategy for older people, which sets out the government's commitment to older people and the actions that will be taken to improve their lives. The strategy is based on the principle that older people should be able to live independently, safely and with dignity. It sets out a range of actions that will be taken to improve the lives of older people, including: improving the quality of care and support for older people; improving the housing and transport needs of older people; and improving the social and economic conditions of older people.

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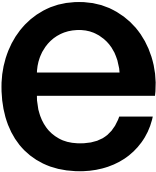


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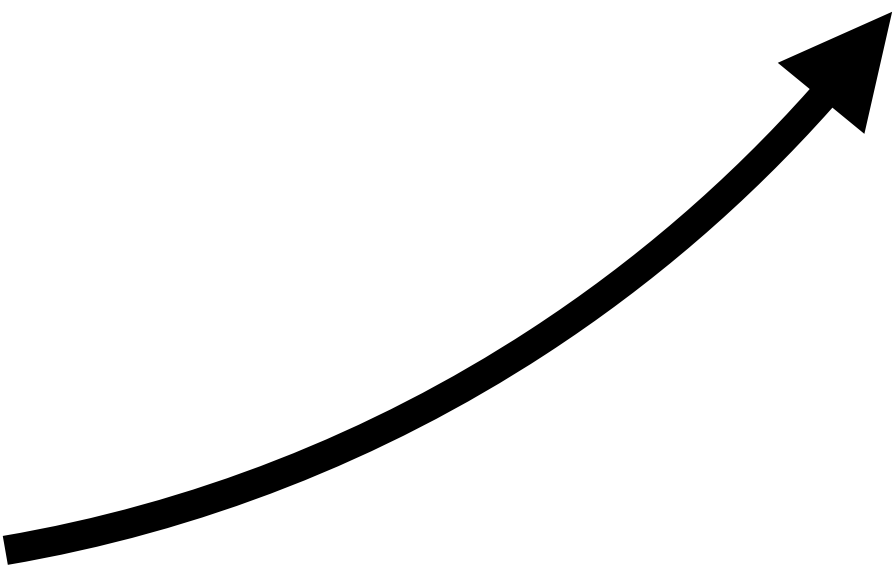








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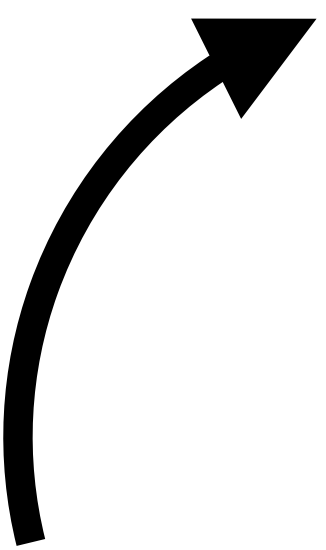


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